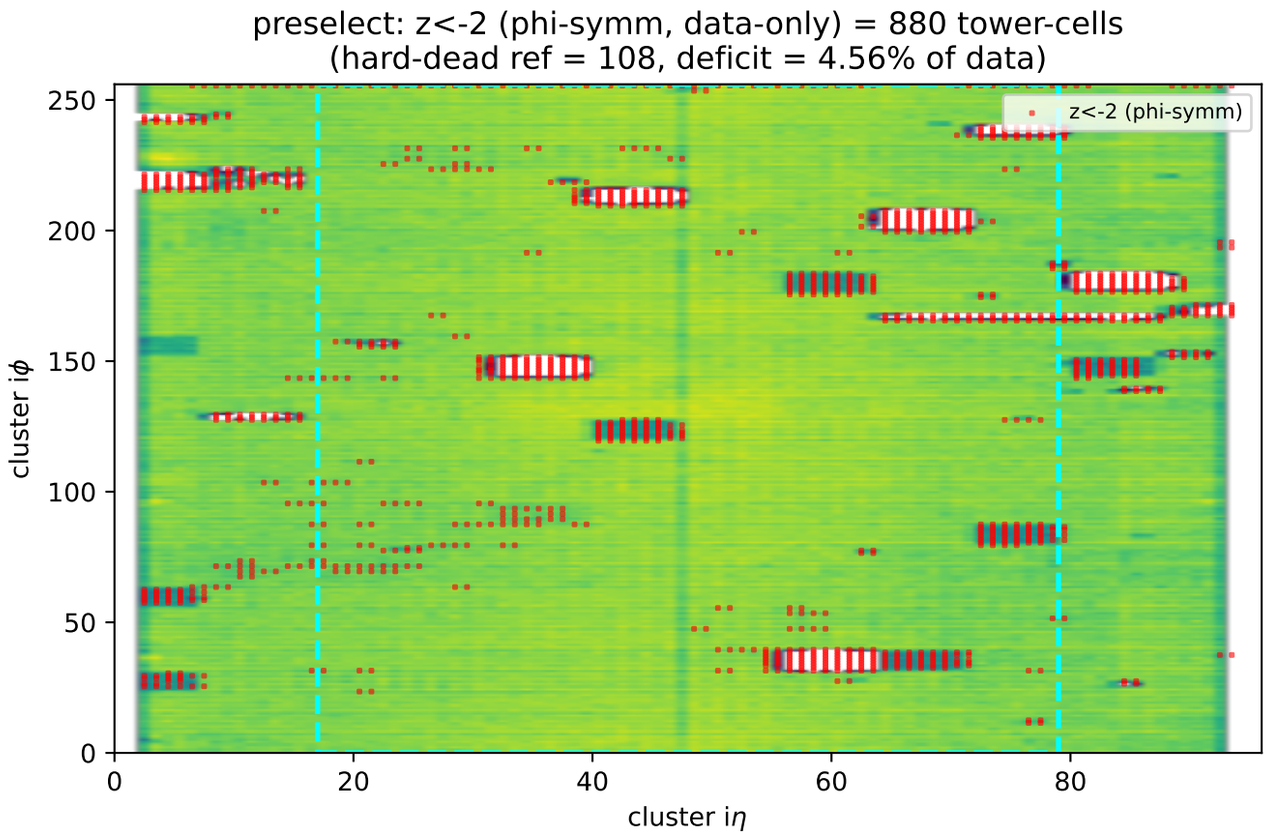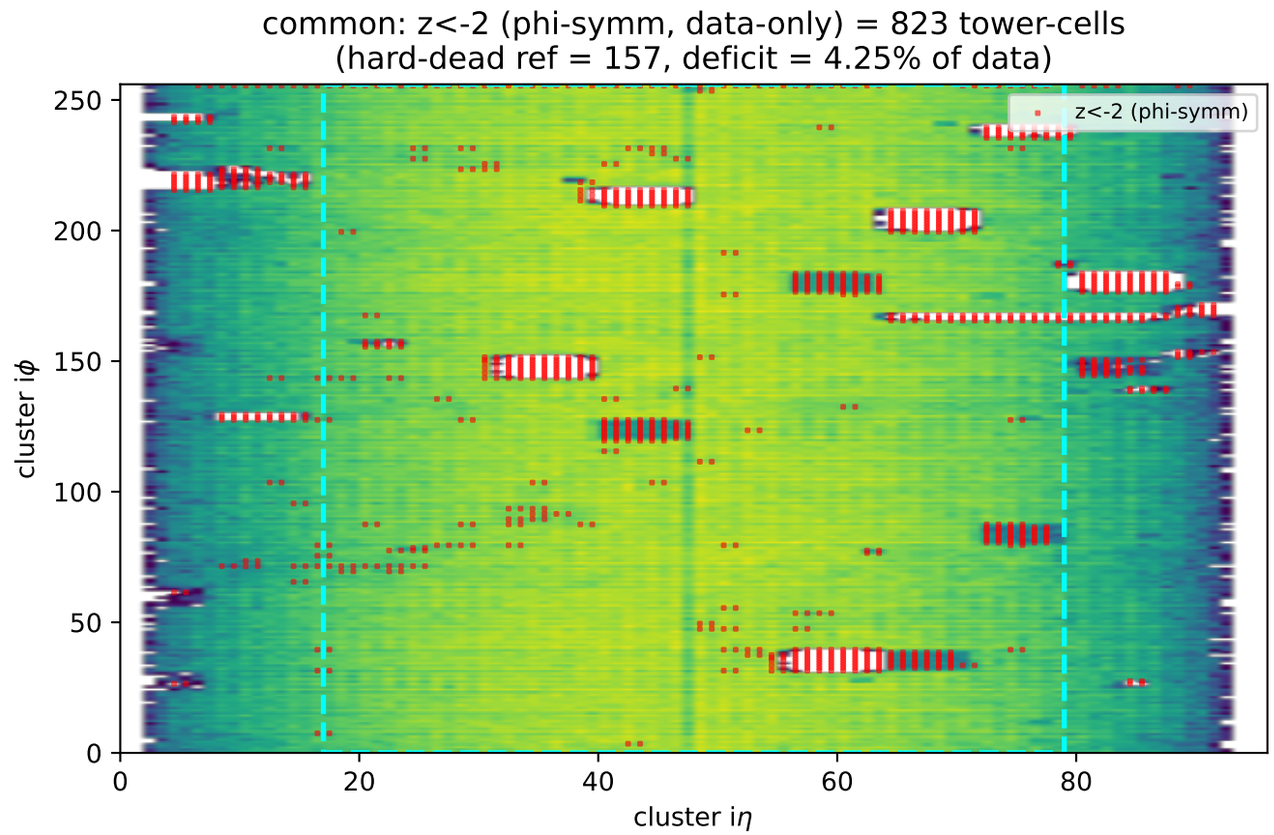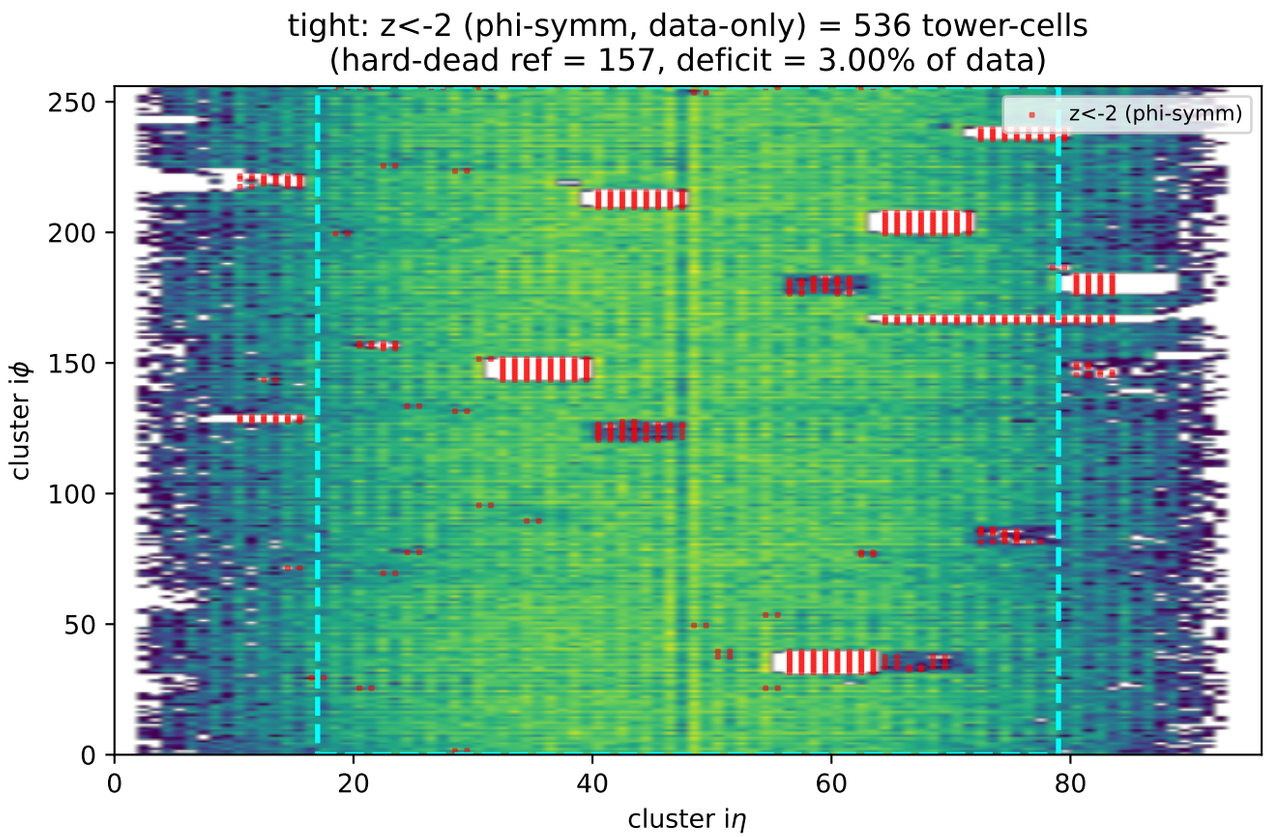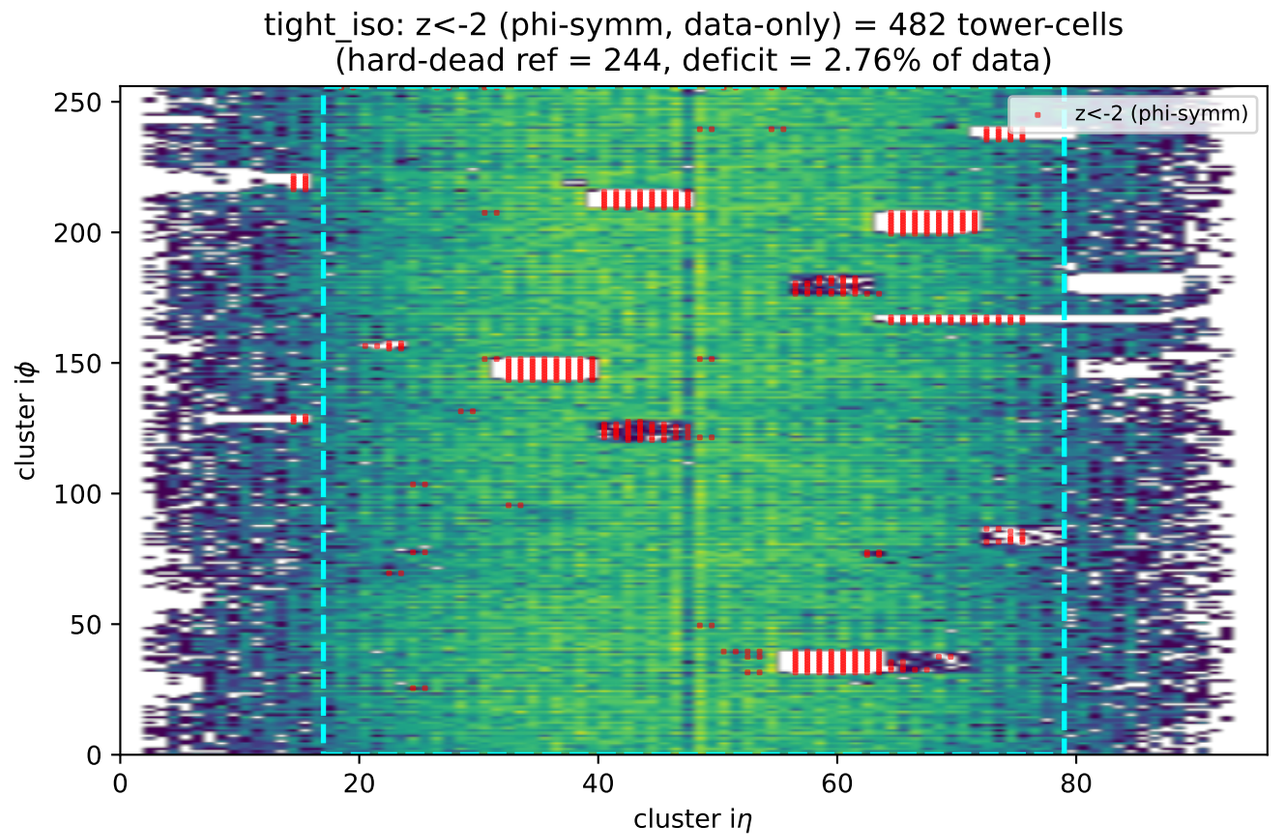Alt check 2: data-only phi-symmetry dead-tower finder
(group 2 eta rows; fit Gaussian to per-phi counts; flag z<-2)